

Jamie Burkart

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Re: Senior Product Designer — PIT Crew, Job ID 782373

Dear NYC Office of Technology and Innovation Hiring Team,

At a coalition working session at Shoestring Press, I crouched in a garden circle beside shared handwritten notes while participants tried to align around the work ahead. The notes made a difficult conversation visible: names, relationships, unresolved questions, and possible next actions could be pointed to, revised, and shared. That moment has stayed with me because it names what design often does before there is an interface. It gives people a common object through which they can understand one another and decide what happens next.

I would bring that practice to the PIT Crew Senior Product Designer role. Across Thick Arts, CallNYC, WOW List, Let NYC Dance, NYC Artist Coalition, FairRentNYC, and KC Town Hall, I have moved from resident and stakeholder listening through journey framing, information architecture, content and interaction design, graphic and web design, prototyping, implementation, public launch, support, and iteration. Because I also build front-end and publishing systems, I design with engineering handoff, responsive behavior, maintainability, source boundaries, and real operating constraints in view.

CallNYC translated constituent-services data into issue pages and next-step guidance, while remaining explicit that the independent prototype was not an official City service. WOW List replaced a complex event form with a single collaboratively editable text field. Tired of Tires joined a flyer and web surface to form and phone intake, field collection, City recycling, and public reporting. The decisive test in each case was not visual polish alone. It was whether the designed surface helped a person enter the system, understand what was possible, and act without being asked to know how the whole institution worked.

I would welcome a structured design exercise around one resident service: listen for the real question, map the journey and hidden handoffs, prototype the smallest useful path in plain language, test it with the people who must use and operate it, and identify what accessibility and trust require before launch. The durable result should be a service residents can navigate and a design system the City can keep learning through after the first release.

Warmly,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Jamie Burkart', with a long, sweeping horizontal line extending to the right.

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